

Grade 4 Programme of Inquiry, 2019–20

The year at a glance: six inquiry units, one for each IB transdisciplinary theme, each built around a central idea, three lines of inquiry, and a focus set of attributes and skills.

Produced by

The Grade 4 team through the seven-step Programme of Inquiry review

Aligned to

IB PYP framework, Mexico's national (SEP) curriculum, NGSS, and Common Core

1 Who we are Healthy Habits

The decisions we make affect our habits.

- How animals process and respond to information **causation**
- How we establish our eating habits **connection**
- Decision making **responsibility**

Learner profile

Open-minded, principled, reflective

Skills

Social, self-management

2 How we express ourselves Movement and Expression

Cultural preservation unifies the communication of ideas, values, and feelings.

- Movement as energy and expression **function**
- Sound waves and their patterns **change**
- How people preserve culture through movement and sound **perspective**

Learner profile

Risk-takers, balanced, knowledgeable

Skills

Social, self-management

3 How we organize ourselves Navigation

The solar system plays a central role in human life.

- Relationship between the moon, Earth, and sun **connection**
- Sources of heat and light and how people use them **function**
- Navigational instruments **form, function**

Learner profile

Thinkers, open-minded, inquirers

Skills

Research, thinking

4 Where we are in place and time Maps and Legends

People respond to the natural geographical features of the Earth.

- How geography determines human settlement **causation**
- How geography shapes natural boundaries **form**
- The impact of natural disasters **change**

Learner profile

Communicators, thinkers, inquirers

Skills

Thinking, communication

5 How the world works Biodiversity and Tourism

People visit a place for a variety of reasons.

- Tourism as a means of economic development **function**
- The connection between biodiversity and tourism **connection**
- Cultural diversity **perspective**

Learner profile

Knowledgeable, communicators, balanced

Skills

Research, communication

6 Sharing the planet Environmental Issues

Balance mitigates pollution and sustains Earth's resources.

- Natural resources and how they are obtained **form**
- Human responsibility toward sustainability **responsibility**
- Causes of pollution **causation**

Learner profile

Caring, balanced, reflective

Skills

Self-management, research

Small tags show the key concept each line of inquiry explores. Units are listed in teaching order.

Inside one unit: Healthy Habits

How a single inquiry unit carries three curricula at once, so students meet IB, Mexican, and U.S. requirements through one connected investigation instead of separate lessons.

Theme

Who we are

Central idea

The decisions we make affect our habits.

IB PYP framework

What makes it an inquiry

Lines of inquiry

How animals process and respond to information **causation**

How we establish our eating habits **connection**

Decision making **responsibility**

Learner profile

Open-minded, principled, reflective

Approaches to learning

Social and self-management skills

Mexico's national curriculum

SEP outcome covered in this unit

Learning outcome

Analyzes the characteristics of a diet and compares it to their own eating habits.

U.S. standards

NGSS and Common Core, integrated into the inquiry

Science (NGSS)

4-LS1-2 Use a model to describe how animals receive information through their senses, process it in the brain, and respond in different ways.

Writing (Common Core)

W.4.2 (a-e) Write informative texts that introduce a topic, develop it with facts and details, link ideas, use precise vocabulary, and conclude.

W.4.7, 4.8, 4.9 Conduct short research projects, gather and take notes from print and digital sources, and draw evidence from texts.

Reading (Common Core)

RI.4.1, 4.4, 4.7 Refer to details in informational texts, determine the meaning of domain vocabulary, and interpret information presented visually.

Math (Common Core)

4.NBT.A.1-3, B.4 Place value, reading and comparing multi-digit numbers, rounding, and multi-digit addition and subtraction.

4.G.A.3 Lines of symmetry, explored through objects people use and consume, including the human body.

1

central idea

3

lines of inquiry

1

SEP outcome

1

NGSS standard

17

Common Core standards

All taught through one connected inquiry.